SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #64 · HEAVEN

“In heaven I’ll be grieving for the people who aren’t there.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Loving family members or friends who do not follow Christ. Fear that heaven cannot be happy if they are missing. Grief over a loved one who died without apparent faith. A tender heart that cannot imagine joy without the people you love. Not knowing how Scripture speaks about sorrow in heaven.

What Scripture teaches

This is a deep and loving concern, and Scripture does not answer every question about it. But it does promise that God will wipe away every tear and there will be no more mourning, crying, or pain. We will know fully, as we are fully known, and we will see God’s perfect justice and love clearly. The Judge of all the earth will do what is right. We can trust that heaven’s joy will not be shadowed by sorrow, even though we cannot yet understand how.

> *“‘He will wipe away every tear from their eyes,’ and there will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain, for the former things have passed away”* **(Revelation 21:4)**.

Also see

> “He will swallow up death forever. The Lord GOD will wipe away the tears from every face and remove the disgrace of His people from the whole earth. For the LORD has spoken” **(Isaiah 25:8)**.

> “Far be it from You to do such a thing—to kill the righteous with the wicked, so that the righteous and the wicked are treated alike. Far be it from You! Will not the Judge of all the earth do what is right?” **(Genesis 18:25)**.

> “Now we see but a dim reflection as in a mirror; then we shall see face to face. Now I know in part; then I shall know fully, even as I am fully known” **(1 Corinthians 13:12)**.

> “O, the depth of the riches of the wisdom and knowledge of God! How unsearchable are His judgments, and untraceable His ways!” **(Romans 11:33)**.

Common self-statements

- I can’t be happy in heaven without them.
- Heaven will feel empty if they’re not there.
- I’ll spend eternity missing someone.
- How can God expect me to rejoice?
- Heaven can’t be perfect if people I love are lost.
- I’d rather not think about heaven at all.

Common logical errors

- **Fortune telling:** Predicting what you will feel in heaven based on earthly limits.
- **Emotional reasoning:** Concluding that because you feel this sorrow now, you must feel it forever.
- **Limited perspective:** Judging eternity from partial knowledge.
- **Avoidance:** Not thinking about heaven because the question hurts.

Challenging questions

- What does Revelation 21:4 promise about tears and mourning?
- Will I understand God's ways more fully in heaven?
- Can I trust the Judge of all the earth to do what is right?
- Is it possible God can heal sorrow in ways I can't imagine?
- What can I do now for the people I love who don't know Christ?
- Can I grieve now and still trust God for later?
- What do I know of God's character that helps me trust Him here?

Truth summary

> I cannot answer every question about heaven, but I can trust God's promise: He will wipe away every tear, and there will be no more mourning. I will know fully, and I will see His justice and love clearly. The Judge of all the earth will do what is right. I can pray for the people I love today and trust God with what I don't understand.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Heaven
- Grief
- Witness
- Trust
- God, All Loving

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Death and Dying
- Grief

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "In heaven I'll be grieving for the people who aren't there"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"In heaven I'll be grieving for the people who aren't there." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does God promise about tears in heaven?
- ☐ Will I understand more fully then?
- ☐ Can I trust God to do what is right?
- ☐ Can God heal sorrow in ways I can't imagine?
- ☐ What can I do now for those I love?
- ☐ Can I grieve now and trust God for later?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God will wipe away every tear.
- ☐ There will be no more mourning in heaven.
- ☐ The Judge of all the earth will do what is right.
- ☐ I will know fully, even as I am fully known.
- ☐ I can trust God with what I don't understand.
- ☐ I can pray for the people I love today.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Revelation 21:4**
  "'He will wipe away every tear from their eyes,' and there will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain, for the former things have passed away."
- [ ] **Isaiah 25:8**
  "He will swallow up death forever. The Lord GOD will wipe away the tears from every face and remove the disgrace of His people from the whole earth. For the LORD has spoken."
- [ ] **Genesis 18:25**
  "Far be it from You to do such a thing—to kill the righteous with the wicked, so that the righteous and the wicked are treated alike. Far be it from You! Will not the Judge of all the earth do what is right?"
- [ ] **1 Corinthians 13:12**
  "Now we see but a dim reflection as in a mirror; then we shall see face to face. Now I know in part; then I shall know fully, even as I am fully known."
- [ ] **Romans 11:33**
  "O, the depth of the riches of the wisdom and knowledge of God! How unsearchable are His judgments, and untraceable His ways!"

A verse I found myself: _____

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Prayer list:** Each day, pray for one person I love who does not know Christ, and write their name.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Revelation 21:4 becomes: "He will wipe away every tear from **Sarah's** eyes, and there will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain, for the former things have passed away."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Heaven" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Write the names of loved ones you worry about,** and pray for each one this week.
- ☐ **Share your faith gently with one person,** or simply show them Christ's love in a practical way.
- ☐ **Read Romans 11:33–36,** and write what it says about God's wisdom.
- ☐ **Talk with a pastor** about your questions and grief.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "In heaven I'll be grieving for the people who aren't there": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One person I prayed for
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~In heaven I'll be grieving for the people who aren't there.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You know how much I love the people You have given me. I don't understand everything about heaven, but I trust Your promise to wipe away every tear. Help me reject the fear that heaven will be shadowed by grief. Draw my loved ones to Yourself, and help me trust You with what I cannot understand. In Jesus' name, Amen.

✦ ✦ ✦

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.